

Mumbai-born Harmeet Singh, now a key member of the USA side, did not mince words. “We do have a few stadiums in the USA, but infrastructure isn’t in the players’ control. What we need are more facilities and stronger development systems,” he said.

“Back in the 1990s, even India faced infrastructure challenges. But once academies like the National Cricket Academy were established and quality coaching systems were put in place, Indian cricket changed completely,” he added. “The difference between us becoming a top nation and where we are right now is infrastructure.

This team has immense potential. We just need more international games, more series against top sides, and the confidence that comes from finishing games against them.”

That sentiment echoes across dressing rooms.

“I think it’s not rocket science. If you play more cricket, you’re going to get better. And especially if you play more competitive cricket. So I think all the Associate nations are calling out for the same thing,” Namibia coach Craig Williams said.

The T20 World Cup has become the ICC’s chosen instrument of expansion. Since the 2024 edition, the tournament has grown from 16 to 20 teams, underlining T20’s role as the format through which the game hopes to widen its footprint. But expansion cannot end with adding names to a draw sheet every two years.

Associate nations need sustained exposure against Full Members through regular bilateral opportunities, high-quality competition and meaningful calendar space.

The appetite exists. The potential is evident. If that broader pathway begins to take shape, the upsets that once felt fleeting could become part of a more competitive global game.



Cruel margin: Max O'Dowd put down Faheem Ashraf at long-off, a moment that slipped through the Netherlands' fingers as Pakistan escaped with the match.
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Associate nations against full members in T20Is

Team	Total Matches played	Won	Loss	NR	Tied
Scotland	33	6	24	2	1
Canada	8	2	5	0	1
Netherlands	37	10	25	1	1
Nepal	11	2	9	0	0
United Arab Emirates	36	11	25	0	0
Oman	11	1	10	0	0
United States of America	11	3	7	0	1
Italy	4	1	3	0	0

Only teams playing the T20 World Cup 2026 are considered

Associate nations since the 2024 T20 World Cup

Team	T20Is played	vs Full member sides	Last scheduled T20I	Opponent	Venue
Scotland	10	3 (vs Australia)	11 July 2025	Jersey	Schiedam
Canada	24	0	22 June 2025	Bermuda	King City
Netherlands	18	3 (vs Bangladesh)	3 September 2025	Bangladesh	Sylhet
Nepal	24	3 (vs West Indies)	17 October 2026	Samoa	Al Amerat
United Arab Emirates	41	11	31 January 2026	Ireland	Dubai
Oman	27	2	16 November 2025	UAE	Doha
United States of America	20	0	27 April 2025	Canada	Grand Cayman
Italy	6	3 (vs Ireland)	26 January 2026	Ireland	Dubai

Matches considered till the start of the 2026 T20 World Cup